behavior, and the IPCC forecasts a further increase of 2.5–9.9 °F (1.4–5.5°C) during the next 100 years.

The life cycles of plants and animals change in line with the seasons. Phenology is the study of these seasonal changes. They may be triggered by temperature, rainfall, or the length of daylight, but temperature is probably the single most important factor in Earth's temperate and polar regions, whereas rainfall is the key factor in the tropics. In 2003, climate change scientists Camille Parmesan and Gary Yohe proved that spring change is now happening earlier—a phenomenon called spring creep.